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Dear students,

Student Success: I am committed to supporting the success of all students, and I recognize that different students have different needs. I celebrate the many ways scientists bring their complex sensibilities and their unique personalities to our fields. I work to encourage STEM communities to welcome scientists from all backgrounds by identifying and resolving barriers to student success.

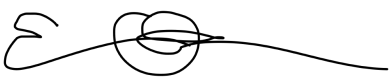
Teaching Statement: I have developed classes that prepare students for real-world scenarios through project-based learning, intentional training situations, and the use of real tools of the trade. My *immediate goals* are to facilitate understanding of the learning objectives of each course. **However, my *ultimate goals* are to ignite curiosity and foster skillsets that empower students to be lifelong learners.**

Cultivating a positive classroom: I strive to ensure our classroom, our virtual spaces, and our interactions are respectful and kind. Mutual respect, civility, and good communication are crucial to foster the trust required for learning and teaching. I ask that you all join me in taking on the personal responsibility to treat one another with empathy, kindness, and respect.

Names & Pronouns: I prefer to be called "Erin", "Dr. Nishimura", or just "Professor". I am not picky. I pronounce my last name, Nishimura, as "Knee-she-mura" with the "u" in "mura" sounding like "fur". Other Japanese Americans use different pronunciations such as a short 'i' sound (as in "knit"). I use she/her pronouns. I want to get your names and pronouns right. Please be patient with me if I ask you to teach me your proper name pronunciation and pronouns.

The history of our fields: The fields of computation and biochemistry have histories fraught with stereotypes, biases, and even serious power abuses. In the US, these fields were historically dominated by scientists from traditionally majority identities, and that is also what has been depicted in fiction and film. If left unexamined, this history can unfairly narrow our assumptions about what is possible in the field and what we and others can achieve. However, I want our communities to be healthy, and I want all students to feel inspired. Acknowledging our history is the first step to empowering a healthier future for the community and for ourselves. I'm excited to work with you and get to know all of you.

Sincerely,



Erin Nishimura, PhD